



Quick Start Guide

Pediatric Nutrition Tools

Open in any browser: pat-dubois.github.io/peds-nutrition-calc/index-v2.html

Little Spoon is a pediatric nutrition calculator with three tools in one page. It works on your phone, tablet, or computer. Bookmark it for quick access between patients.

Privacy: No patient data is ever saved or sent anywhere. When you close the page, everything is gone. It also works offline once loaded.

All three tabs share the **Patient** section at the top (weight, height, gender). Fill that in first, then pick your tab. The **Reset** button clears everything across all three tabs at once.

Tab 1 Nutrition

Calculates daily energy, protein, and fluid requirements.

WHAT TO ENTER

- **Weight** (kg) and **Height** (cm) in the Patient section
- **Gender** - tap Male or Female
- **Age** in years and months
- **Activity level** - only needed for children 3 years and older

Tap **Calculate** and you'll get three results:

ENERGY

1,245 kcal/day

PROTEIN

23.8 g/day

FLUID

1,500 mL/day

Each result shows the per-kg rate in brackets. Tap **Show calculation** under any result to see the full formula and step-by-step math.

WHO growth chart Z-scores and percentiles for children 0 to 5 years.

WHAT TO ENTER

- **Weight, Height, and Gender** in the Patient section
- **Date of Birth** and **Date of Measurement** (defaults to today)
- **Head circumference** - optional, only shows results if entered
- **BMI or Weight-for-Length** - toggle between the two

Tap **Calculate** to get Z-scores and percentiles for:

- Weight-for-Age
- Length-for-Age (under 2) or Height-for-Age (2 and up)
- BMI-for-Age or Weight-for-Length (your choice)
- Head Circumference-for-Age (when entered)

Z-Score Color Coding

- **Green** - Normal range ● **Gold** - Mild concern ($Z \pm 1$ to ± 2) ● **Orange** - Moderate ($Z \pm 2$ to ± 3)
- **Red** - Severe (Z beyond ± 3)

Note: The Growth tab covers ages 0-5 years (0-60 months), which is the range of the WHO Child Growth Standards.

Quick-reference table of daily vitamin and mineral requirements by age group. Covers 14 vitamins and 12 minerals across all pediatric age ranges.

WHAT TO ENTER

- **Gender** in the Patient section
- **Age group** from the dropdown (0-6 months through 14-18 years)

Important: For the **9-13 years** and **14-18 years** age groups, you must select Male or Female first. Some nutrient needs differ by gender at those ages. The table won't load without a gender selected.

Reading the Table

- **Teal values** = RDA (Recommended Dietary Allowance) - backed by strong research evidence. Set to meet the needs of 97-98% of healthy children in that age group.
- **Blue values with asterisk (*)** = AI (Adequate Intake) - best available estimate when research isn't conclusive enough to set an RDA. Still the official recommendation.
- UL **UL column** = Tolerable Upper Intake Level - the maximum daily amount unlikely to cause harm. A dash means no upper limit has been established.

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For clinical use. Always verify calculations with clinical judgment.

Sources: Health Canada 2023 DRI Equations · Holliday-Segar (1957) · WHO Child Growth Standards · IOM Dietary Reference Intakes (1997-2011)